

Word family: **fancy / fancies / fancied / fancying / fanciful / fancifully / fanciness**

Base word: fancy

Past tense: fancied

Past participle: fancied

-ing form: fancying

Related forms: fanciful, fancifully, fanciness

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “We did not need expensive toys or **fancy plans**, because we could turn almost anything into fun.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **fancy** means **elaborate, impressive, stylish, or more complicated/luxurious than necessary**.

The speaker means they did not need elaborate or special plans in order to have fun.

繁體中文： **華麗的、講究的、特別精心安排的，或比實際需要更複雜 / 高級的**

中文翻譯：

> “We did not need expensive toys or **fancy plans**...”

「我們不需要昂貴的玩具，也不需要甚麼**講究 / 花巧的計劃**.....」

Here:

fancy plans = 精心安排、花巧或很講究的活動計劃

1. **fancy = elaborate / stylish / luxurious (外觀 / 安排) — 華麗的；講究的；高級的；花巧的**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: More elaborate, stylish, decorative, expensive, or sophisticated than something ordinary or necessary.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We did not need expensive toys or **fancy plans**.”

「我們不需要昂貴的玩具或甚麼**花巧 / 講究的計劃**。」

Practice 2

> “They stayed in a **fancy** hotel near the harbour.”

「他們住在港口附近一間很**高級 / 豪華**的酒店。」

Practice 3

> “You don’t need any **fancy** equipment to start.”

「你開始時不需要任何**高級 / 花巧的**設備。」

****fancy = 外觀、設計、安排或質素較普通事物更華麗、精緻、高級或複雜****

Common:

- * fancy restaurant
- * fancy hotel
- * fancy clothes
- * fancy equipment
- * fancy design
- * fancy plan

The exact Chinese changes by context:

- * fancy clothes → 華麗 / 時髦的衣服
- * fancy restaurant → 高級餐廳
- * fancy equipment → 高級 / 複雜設備
- * fancy plan → 花巧 / 講究的計劃

These belong to one broad sense.

2. ****fancy = decorative / complicated in design (設計) — 花式的 ; 裝飾華麗的****

A closely related adjective use focuses specifically on visual complexity or decoration.

Practice 4

> “The invitation had **fancy** lettering.”

「邀請卡用了很**花巧 / 華麗的字體**。」

Practice 5

> “The cake was covered in ****fancy**** decorations.”

「蛋糕上佈滿了****精緻華麗的裝飾****。」

****fancy** = 帶有較多裝飾、圖案或複雜設計的******

For database counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1 rather than split it.

The Golden Manual says different objects or Chinese renderings should not create extra senses when one semantic idea still works.

3. ****fancy** = want / feel like (英式口語動詞) — 想要；想做******

As a verb, especially in British English, ****fancy**** can mean ****want something or feel like doing something****.

Practice 6

> “Do you ****fancy**** a cup of tea?”

「你****想不想喝****杯茶？」

Practice 7

> “I don’t ****fancy**** going out tonight.”

「我今晚****不太想****出去。」

****fancy something / fancy doing something** = 想要某物，或想做某件事；英式口語******

This is a genuinely distinct verb meaning.

4. ****fancy** = be attracted to someone (英式口語) — 對某人有好感；覺得某人有吸引力******

****Fancy**** can also mean to feel romantic or sexual attraction toward someone.

Practice 8

> “I think he ****fancies**** her.”

「我覺得他**對她有意思 / 喜歡她**。」

Practice 9

> “She used to **fancy** one of her classmates.”

「她以前曾經**對其中一位同學有好感**。」

fancy someone = 對某人有浪漫或性方面的吸引 / 好感；英式口語

This is related historically to “like/want,” but for learners it is distinct enough to show separately.

5. **fancy = imagine / suppose (較舊 / 文學) — 想像；以為**

Fancy can mean to imagine, suppose, or form an idea in the mind.

Practice 10

> “I **fancied** I heard someone outside.”

「我**好像覺得 / 以為**聽到外面有人。」

Practice 11

> “She **fancied** herself living by the sea.”

「她**想像**自己住在海邊。」

fancy = 在腦中想像、設想或認為某件事情

This is established but less common in everyday modern English than the previous verb uses.

6. **fancy yourself as something (自我想像 / 自認) — 自認為；自命為**

A common figurative construction is:

> **fancy yourself as + role**

or simply:

> **fancy yourself + adjective/noun**

Practice 12

> “He **fancies himself as** a writer.”

「他**自認為** / 自命為**作家**。」

Practice 13

> “She **fancies herself** quite an expert.”

「她**自認為**是個相當厲害的專家。」

fancy yourself as something = 自己想像或認定自己具有某種身分、能力或特質

This belongs to the **imagine/suppose** family.

7. **fancy** = unusual preference/liking (名詞) — 愛好；喜愛；偏好

As a noun, **fancy** can mean a liking or desire for something.

Practice 14

> “She took a **fancy** to the little cottage.”

「她突然**喜歡上**那間小屋。」

Practice 15

> “He has a **fancy** for old watches.”

「他很**喜歡** / 偏愛**古董手錶**。」

a fancy for something = 對某物的喜愛、偏好或興趣

This noun use is less central than the adjective and verb meanings but still useful.

8. **take/catch someone's fancy** — 引起興趣；討人喜歡

This is a useful fixed expression.

Practice 16

> “The blue jacket **caught my fancy**.”

「那件藍色外套**吸引了我 / 令我很喜歡**。」

Practice 17

> “Nothing on the menu really **took her fancy**.”

「餐牌上沒有甚麼真正**引起她的興趣 / 合她心意**。」

take/catch someone's fancy = 引起某人的興趣、喜愛或慾望

This is an idiom rather than a new bare-word sense.

9. **fancy** = imaginative / unreal (名詞 , 較文學) — 想像 ; 幻想

As a noun, **fancy** can also mean imagination or a mental image that is not based on reality.

Practice 18

> “It was only a product of his **fancy**.”

「那只是他**幻想 / 想像**出來的東西。」

Practice 19

> “Her mind was full of strange **fancies**.”

「她腦中充滿奇怪的**幻想**。」

fancy = 不一定基於現實的想像、幻想或念頭

This is more literary and lower-priority for modern learners.

Related form: **fanciful**

Fanciful means imaginative but unrealistic, often in an elaborate or whimsical way.

Practice 20

> “The story is full of **fanciful** creatures.”

「這個故事充滿各種**幻想出來的奇異生物**。」

Practice 21

> “That explanation seems rather **fanciful**.”

「那個解釋看起來相當**不切實際 / 富於幻想**。」

fanciful = 富於想像但不太現實、甚至有點異想天開的

Related form: **fancifully**

Practice 22

> “The room was **fancifully** decorated.”

「房間被裝飾得非常**富於幻想 / 花巧**。」

fancifully = 以富於想像、花巧或不太現實的方式

Related form: **fanciness**

Fanciness means the quality of being fancy, elaborate, decorative, or luxurious.

Practice 23

> “The restaurant relies more on quality than **fanciness**.”

「這間餐廳更重視品質，而不是**華麗講究的排場**。」

This is a real form, but lower-frequency.

Important distinction: **fancy** vs **expensive**

fancy

can mean:

* stylish

* elaborate

- * decorative
- * sophisticated

expensive

simply means:

> costing a lot of money

A thing can be:

> fancy but inexpensive

or:

> expensive but plain

So in your sentence:

> “expensive toys or fancy plans”

the two adjectives are deliberately not identical.

Important distinction: **fancy vs luxurious**

luxurious

strongly suggests:

- * comfort
- * high quality
- * expense

fancy

is broader and can simply mean:

- * elaborate
- * decorative
- * sophisticated

> fancy handwriting

does not mean:

> luxurious handwriting

Important distinction: **fancy vs complicated**

complicated

means difficult because it contains many parts or details.

fancy

may mean elaborate or sophisticated, but does **not necessarily** mean difficult.

> fancy equipment

may be advanced or sophisticated.

> complicated equipment

focuses on difficulty/complexity.

Important distinction: **fancy vs want**

In British conversational English:

> “Do you fancy some coffee?”

≈

> “Do you want some coffee?”

But **fancy** is more informal and often suggests:

> feel like / be in the mood for

So:

want = 想要

fancy = 想不想 / 有沒有興致 ; 較口語

Important distinction: ****fancy someone vs like someone****

****like someone****

can simply mean you enjoy their personality or company.

****fancy someone****

usually implies romantic/sexual attraction.

So:

> “I like him.”

does not necessarily mean romance.

> “I fancy him.”

usually does.

Important distinction: ****fancy vs imagine****

****imagine****

is the neutral modern word for forming a mental picture or possibility.

****fancy****

in this sense is more literary, old-fashioned, or stylistically marked.

> “Imagine living there.”

more neutral.

> “Fancy living there!”

can also function as an exclamation expressing surprise.

Fixed expression: ****Fancy that! — 真想不到 ! ****

Practice 24

> “He won the competition? **Fancy that!**”

「他贏了比賽？**真想不到！**」

Practice 25

> “They met again twenty years later—**fancy that!**”

「他們二十年後竟然再遇上——**真巧 / 真想不到！**」

Fancy that! = 表示驚訝、意外或覺得事情很不可思議

This is a fixed exclamatory use.

Fixed expression: **fancy doing something! — 竟然……！**

Practice 26

> “**Fancy meeting** you here!”

「**真想不到會在這裡遇到你！**」

Practice 27

> “**Fancy forgetting** your own birthday!”

「**竟然連自己的生日都忘了！**」

Here, **fancy + -ing** expresses surprise rather than desire.

This is worth keeping separate from:

> “Do you fancy going out?”

because the grammar looks similar but the function differs.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **fancy**

* **fancies**
 * **fancied**
 * **fancying**
 * **fanciful**
 * **fancifully**
 * **fanciness**

Useful constructions include:

* fancy restaurant
 * fancy equipment
 * fancy doing something
 * fancy someone
 * fancy yourself as
 * take/catch someone's fancy
 * Fancy that!
 * Fancy meeting you here!

The Golden Manual requires grammatical constructions and figurative uses to be checked, but asks us to merge contexts that share the same underlying concept and avoid multiplying meanings just because the Chinese translation changes.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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fancy — elaborate/stylish/luxurious	外觀、設計、安排或質素較普通事物更華麗、精緻、高級或複雜的
fancy something / doing something	想要某物或有興致做某事；英式口語
fancy someone	對某人有浪漫或性方面的吸引 / 好感；英式口語
fancy — imagine/suppose	在腦中想像、設想或認為某件事情；較文學 / 較舊
a fancy for something	對某物的喜愛、偏好或興趣
fancy — imagination/fantasy noun	不一定基於現實的想像、幻想或念頭；較文學
fanciful	富於想像但不太現實、甚至有點異想天開的
Fancy that!	表示驚訝或意外：真想不到！
Fancy + -ing!	表示對某件事情感到驚訝：竟然……！

For your original sentence

> “We did not need expensive toys or **fancy plans**...”

The exact meaning is:

fancy = 比一般情況更講究、花巧、精心安排或複雜的

So:

> **fancy plans**

= **花巧 / 講究 / 特別精心安排的計劃**

The contrast in the sentence is:

> **expensive toys** = 昂貴的玩具

> **fancy plans** = 花巧、講究、精心安排的計劃

For your database, I would count **5 genuinely useful core meanings** for **fancy**:

1. **adjective — elaborate / stylish / luxurious / sophisticated**
2. **verb — want / feel like**
3. **verb — be romantically attracted to someone**
4. **verb — imagine / suppose**
5. **noun — liking, desire, imagination, or fantasy**

I would merge decorative/high-end adjective uses under #1, keep **fancy yourself as** under #4, and treat **Fancy that!, Fancy meeting you here!, take/catch someone's fancy** as fixed constructions rather than inflate the core count.